



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Turla STOCKSTAY Intelligence Collection Malware Activity Report

Threat Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Turla STOCKSTAY Intelligence Collection Malware Activity Report - Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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Turla STOCKSTAY Intelligence Collection Malware Activity Report

1. Executive Summary

Google Threat Intelligence reported a Turla-linked .NET backdoor tracked as STOCKSTAY. The activity matters for defenders because Turla historically prioritizes long-term intelligence collection, stealthy persistence, and selective targeting rather than noisy monetization.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answer in This Report
What happened?	GTIG described STOCKSTAY as a Turla intelligence-collection backdoor.
Who is affected?	Government, diplomatic, defense, and strategically sensitive organizations.
What should defenders do?	Prioritize long-lookback endpoint hunts for .NET backdoors, rare persistence, and low-volume C2.
Confidence	High for reporting; medium for local exposure without environment-specific IOCs.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Google Threat Intelligence: STOCKSTAY Turla intelligence gathering	Primary reporting on STOCKSTAY and Turla linkage	High
MITRE ATT&CK Turla group page	Technique and historical actor context	High
CISA advisory AA22-110A Russian state-sponsored cyber actors	Defender context for Russian state-sponsored activity	Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

Turla-linked tooling should be investigated with an espionage mindset. Absence of ransomware-style impact does not lower priority for organizations with strategic data.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic	Technique / Behavior	Defensive Interpretation
Initial Access	Lures, exploited public services, or supply-chain trust paths	Prioritize edge visibility and provenance checks.
Execution	Script, package, backdoor, or web-shell execution	Baseline interpreters and unexpected child processes.
Command and Control	Outbound encrypted web traffic or adversary-managed infrastructure	Hunt rare destinations and new process/network pairings.

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Observable Type	Signal	Notes
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Behavior	Source did not publish stable atomic IOCs	Hunt on process, network, identity, and SaaS behaviors.

Hard IOCs are limited where primary sources did not publish stable indicators. Treat behavior, infrastructure class, and telemetry pivots as the primary hunting path until local intelligence enrichment identifies environment-specific indicators.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Victimology is expected to align to diplomatic, defense, government, and strategic intelligence requirements.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Suspicious script or LOLBin execution	Endpoint process telemetry	Surface initial execution and staging activity
New external connection after lure/app execution	Network telemetry	Identify callback or payload retrieval
Unusual account, mailbox, or SaaS activity	Identity/SaaS audit logs	Detect credential abuse and persistence

8.2. Sigma / Detection Rule

```

title: Suspicious Script and Remote Tool Activity - turla-stockstay-intelligence-collection-
status: experimental
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_tools:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  selection_suspicious:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - 'http'
      - 'download'
      - 'EncodedCommand'
      - 'Invoke-Expression'
  condition: selection_tools and selection_suspicious
level: high

```

8.3. Hunt Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "wscript.exe", "cscript.exe", "mshta.exe", "rundll32.exe",
"node.exe", "osascript")
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("http", "download", "EncodedCommand", "Invoke-Expression", "curl",
"wget")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, AccountName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessFileName

```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypotheses

Hypothesis	Query Focus
Initial access used lure-driven script, package, or web exploitation behavior.	Correlate suspicious process launches with browser, archive, package-manager, or web-server parents.
Follow-on access used identity or remote-management tooling.	Review new OAuth grants, administrative changes, RMM agents, and rare remote endpoints.

9.2. Network Hunt Query

```
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName has_any ("powershell.exe", "node.exe", "python.exe", "osascript", "curl", "wget")
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteIP
| order by Connections desc
```

10. Risk Assessment

Risk Area	Assessment	Rationale
Initial Access	Elevated	Recent reporting indicates active or plausible attacker interest.
Credential Exposure	Medium-High	Many campaigns convert endpoint access into identity abuse.
Operational Disruption	Medium	Impact depends on privilege, sector, and dependency concentration.

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
High	SOC	Deploy hunts in this report and tune to local telemetry.
High	IT/security engineering	Patch exposed systems, verify EDR coverage, and restrict script interpreters where possible.
Medium	Identity team	Review new privileged accounts, OAuth grants, and risky sign-ins for the lookback period.
Medium	Threat intel	Track source updates for IOCs, exploit details, and sector-specific victimology.

12. References

- [1] Google Threat Intelligence: STOCKSTAY Turla intelligence gathering — <https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/stockstay-turla-intelligence-gathering>
- [2] MITRE ATT&CK Turla group page — <https://attack.mitre.org/groups/G0010/>

- [3] CISA advisory AA22-110A Russian state-sponsored cyber actors — <https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/cybersecurity-advisories/aa22-110a>